Persist Week of August 24, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, August 24th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
- Thursday, August 27th, 2026
- Friday, August 28th, 2026
- Saturday, August 29th, 2026
- Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, August 24th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
- Thursday, August 27th, 2026
- Friday, August 28th, 2026
- Saturday, August 29th, 2026
- Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, August 24th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
- Thursday, August 27th, 2026
- Friday, August 28th, 2026
- Saturday, August 29th, 2026

- Sunday, August 30th, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, August 24th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 27th, 2026
  - Friday, August 28th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 29th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 30th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, August 24th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 27th, 2026
  - Friday, August 28th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 29th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 30th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, August 24th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 27th, 2026
  - Friday, August 28th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 29th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 30th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, August 24th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 27th, 2026
  - Friday, August 28th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 29th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, August 24th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 25th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 26th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Friday, August 28th, 2026
Saturday, August 29th, 2026
Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sumo Deadlift
The sumo deadlift uses a wide stance with the feet turned out and hands gripping inside the legs. This position shortens the pull distance and shifts more demand onto the hips and inner thighs compared to a conventional setup. Keep the chest up and drive your feet apart as the bar leaves the ground. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec
2. Rear Delt Swings; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90sec
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmer's Walk; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press

The barbell bench press is the primary horizontal press of this cycle. Keep the shoulder blades pinched together and down throughout the set. This protects the shoulder and creates a more stable pressing platform. The 20X1 tempo means controlled descent, no pause, then drive. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Barbell Curl; 8 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Back Support Barbell Overhead Tricep Extension or Back Supported Cable Overhead Tricep Extension; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of each full rep. Lower all the way down, rise a quarter of the way up, return to the bottom, then stand fully. The heel elevation keeps the demand almost entirely on the quads. The extra quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time under tension in the hardest position of the squat. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40min Total Work - Easy Effort
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15 stop and perform
- 30sec Wall Sit
- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps R
- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps L
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15 stop and perform
- 30sec Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift
- 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold R
- 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold L

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x 3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x 8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The strict bar dip is the primary tricep and chest pressing movement of this cycle on Fridays. Keep the elbows tracking back rather than flaring wide to protect the shoulder and keep the load where it belongs. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, one second pause at the bottom, then

drive. Use assistance as needed to hit the prescribed reps at the prescribed tempo. Reps are consistent across the first three sets with a max unbroken drop set at the end.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
2. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
3. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Barbell Bent Over Row
Every 2:30 x 3 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Rack Split Squat
The front rack split squat holds the load in the front rack position, which demands more core and upper back engagement to stay upright than a goblet or suitcase hold. The split stance isolates each leg independently. Keep the front heel flat and drive through it on every rep. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Goblet Cyclist Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Leg Bodyweight Hip Thrust; 6-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Plank Body Saw; 30-60 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Donkey Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The barbell bench press is the primary horizontal press of this cycle. Keep the shoulder blades pinched together and down throughout the set. This protects the shoulder and creates a more stable pressing platform. The 20X1 tempo means controlled descent, no pause, then drive. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmer's Walk; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side

2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of each full rep. Lower all the way down, rise a quarter of the way up, return to the bottom, then stand fully. The heel elevation keeps the demand almost entirely on the quads. The extra quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time under tension in the hardest position of the squat. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Shinbox Switch x 3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x 8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The dip is the main chest and tricep press on Thursdays. Keep your elbows pointing back instead of flaring out wide so your shoulders stay happy. Take three seconds to lower, pause one second at the bottom, then drive up. Use a band or machine to help if you need it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
2. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
3. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.

rest 2 minutes

Loading Note:

This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):

2-3 sets

1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec

2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 45 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift

The sumo deadlift uses a wide stance with your hands gripping inside your legs. That setup makes the pull shorter and puts more work on your hips and inner thighs. Keep your chest up and push your feet apart into the floor as the bar comes up.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Single Leg Bodyweight Hip Thrust; 6-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Single Leg Hand Support DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Plank Body Saw; 30-60 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Donkey Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown:

1-2 sets

1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:

Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x8

2-3 Sets

- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x8

2-3 Sets

- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec

x8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Middle Splits

1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min

4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of each full rep. Lower all the way down, rise a quarter of the way up, return to the bottom, then stand fully. The heel elevation keeps the demand almost entirely on the quads. That extra quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time

under tension in the hardest position of the squat. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Shrug; 20 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Single Arm Farmers Walk; 50ft/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps
3. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 60 sec/side

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead Mobility
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press

The barbell bench press is the primary horizontal press today. Keep the shoulder blades pinched together and down throughout the set. This protects the shoulder and creates a more stable pressing platform. The 20X1 tempo means a controlled descent, no pause at the bottom, then drive. The set finishes with a max unbroken drop set at Set 1 weight, so by the time you reach it, the chest and triceps have already climbed through three progressively harder sets. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight goes up each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Dumbbell Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30-60 sec
2. DB Bent Over Meadows Row; 10-12 reps/side @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Twist Curl; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Barbell Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sumo Deadlift

The sumo deadlift uses a wide stance with the hands gripping inside the legs. That setup shortens the pull and puts more of the work on the hips and inner thighs. Keep the chest up and push the feet apart into the floor as the bar comes up. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight climbs each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Seated Dumbbell Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Russian Step Up; 6-8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Forearm Plank; 30-60 sec
rest 15-30 sec
2. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build core strength. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec

x8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min
4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sumo Deadlift
The sumo deadlift uses a wide stance with your feet turned out and hands gripping inside your knees. This shortens the pull and puts more work on your hips and inner thighs than a regular stance. Drive your feet out into the floor as the bar leaves the ground and keep your chest tall. Reps drop every other week so you can add weight each time sumo comes back.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1\. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2\. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3\. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min)
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min)
3 sets
1\. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2\. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):

3 Sets
8 Dumbbell Burpees
rest 15sec
10 Dumbbell Hang Clean High Pull
rest 15sec
12 Crush Grip Dumbbell Curls
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1\. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2\. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3\. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The barbell bench press is your main pressing lift this cycle. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down and keep them there, which protects the shoulder and gives you a stronger base to press from. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause at the bottom, then drive up. The last set is max unbroken reps at your first working set weight, so leave enough in the tank to finish strong.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
\+
2-3 Sets
1\. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2\. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min)
Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min)
3 sets
1\. Seated Strict Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2\. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min)
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Farmers Carry 50/35\# (Male/Female)
10 DB Burpees 50/35\#
15 Waiter Curls 50/35\#
1 min Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section, continuous movement keeps heart rate high, and isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1\. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2\. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3\. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of every rep. Squat all the way down, come up a quarter, drop back to the bottom, then stand all the way up to finish the rep. Raising your heels keeps the work almost entirely on your quads, and the extra quarter doubles your time in the hardest part of the squat. Reps drop every other week so the weight can climb.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
1\. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2\. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3\. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min)
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min)
3 sets
1\. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2\. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min)
For Time
30/24 Calorie Bike
30 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
30 Air Squat

rest 30sec
24/18 Calorie Bike
24 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
24 Air Squat
rest 30sec
18/14 Calorie Bike
18 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
18 Air Squat
rest 30sec
12/9 Calorie Bike
12 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
12 Air Squat
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1\. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2\. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3\. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min)
40min Total Work - Easy Effort
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15, stop and perform
\- 30sec Wall Sit
\- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps R
\- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps L
20min Timer
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15, stop and perform
\- 30sec Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift
\- 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold R
\- 15sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold L

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min)
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x 3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x 8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The strict bar dip is your main chest and tricep press on Fridays. Keep your elbows tracking back instead of flaring wide, which keeps your shoulders safe and the load where you want it. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, a one second pause at the bottom, then drive up. Use as much assistance as you need to hit the reps at that tempo, then finish with a max unbroken set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
\+
2-3 Sets
1\. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
2\. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
3\. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min)
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min)
3 sets
1\. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2\. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min)
12min Continuous Clock
Bike 500/400m
8-12 Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\# (Male/Female)
10 Left Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1\. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2\. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3\. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4\. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Rack Split Squat
The front rack split squat holds the weight up on your shoulders, which makes your core and upper back work harder to stay tall than a goblet or suitcase hold would. The split stance trains one leg at a time. Keep your front heel flat and drive through it on every rep. Reps drop every other week so you can keep adding weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min)

3 Rounds
1\. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2\. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3\. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min)
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min)
2-3 sets
1\. Cyclist Front Squat; 8 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2\. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
15 Russian KBS
10 Box Jump Step Down 24/20" (Male/Female)
200-250m Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output per set.

F) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1\. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2\. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3\. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

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Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Bench Press
The barbell bench press is your main pressing lift this cycle. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down and keep them there, which protects the shoulder and gives you a stronger base to press from. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause at the bottom, then drive up. The last set is max unbroken reps at your first working set weight, so leave enough in the tank to finish strong.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Farmers Carry 50/35\# (Male/Female)
10 Dumbbell Burpees 50/35\#
15 Waiter Curls 50/35\#
1 min Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of every rep. Squat all the way down, come up a quarter, drop back to the bottom, then stand all the way up to finish the rep. Raising your heels keeps the work almost entirely on your quads, and the extra quarter doubles your time in the hardest part of the squat. Reps drop every other week so the weight can climb.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
30/24 Calorie Bike (Male/Female)
30 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
30 Air Squat
rest 30 sec
24/18 Calorie Bike
24 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
24 Air Squat
rest 30 sec
18/14 Calorie Bike
18 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
18 Air Squat
rest 30 sec
12/9 Calorie Bike
12 GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
12 Air Squat
*15 min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note:
This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30 min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30 min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x 3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x 8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Bar Dip
The strict bar dip is your main chest and tricep press on Thursdays. Keep your elbows tracking back instead of flaring wide, which keeps your shoulders safe and the load where you want it. The 31X1 tempo means three seconds down, a one second pause at the bottom, then drive up. Use as much assistance as you need to hit the reps at that tempo, then finish with a max unbroken set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
2. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
3. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pull down using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Bike 500/400m (Male/Female)
8-12 Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
10 Left Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
2. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
4. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Coach Notes:
Sumo Deadlift
The sumo deadlift is your main pull on Fridays. The wide stance with your hands gripping inside your knees shortens the pull and shifts more of the work onto your hips and inner thighs. Set your back flat, keep your chest up, and drive your feet apart into the floor as the bar comes up. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight climbs each time it comes back.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
3. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. Front Rack Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
15 Russian KB Swings
10 Box Jump Step Down 24/20" (Male/Female)
200-250m Row
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

3. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min
4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat is your main lift to open the week. It adds a quarter rep at the bottom of every rep — squat all the way down, come up a quarter, drop back to the bottom, then stand all the way up to finish. Raising your heels keeps the work almost entirely on your quads, and that extra quarter doubles your time in the hardest part of the squat. Reps drop every other week so the weight can climb.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side

3. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note:
This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
Bike 500/400m (Male/Female)
8-12 Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm Dumbbell Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
10 Left Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
Effort Note:
Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
2. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps
3. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 60 sec/side

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Overhead Mobility
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5/side with 2-3 sec hold
T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min
Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Swimmer x 5 with 5 sec hold in overhead position.

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Bench Press
The barbell bench press is your main pressing lift this cycle. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down and keep them there, which protects the shoulder and gives you a stronger base to press from. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause at the bottom, then drive up. The last set is max unbroken reps at your first working set weight, so leave enough in the tank to finish strong.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
2. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge, Back, Bicep (15 min):
3 Sets
8 Dumbbell Burpees
rest 15sec
10 Dumbbell Hang Clean High Pull
rest 15sec
12 Crush Grip Dumbbell Curls
rest 45-60sec between sets
*Begin with a light weight of around 20-30lb and increase with each set if you are feeling good.
Effort Note:
Short rests are intentionally included to allow for high quality on each movement. This is an extension of the Strength Balance section with a higher heart rate.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5/side with 5 sec hold.
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Coach Notes:
Sumo Deadlift
The sumo deadlift is your main pull on Fridays. The wide stance with your hands gripping inside your knees shortens the pull and shifts more of the work onto your hips and inner thighs. Set your back flat, keep your chest up, and drive your feet apart into the floor as the bar comes up. Reps drop across the odd weeks, so the weight climbs each time it comes back.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
3. Seated Dumbbell Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets

1. Seated Strict Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Strict Bar Dip; 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
15 Russian KB Swings
10 Box Jump Step Down 24/20" (Male/Female)
200-250m Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec

x8
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min
4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.

There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus

Perform

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Sumo Deadlift
The sumo deadlift is the foundation of pulling strength this cycle. The wide stance and inside grip shorten the pull and load the hips, glutes, and inner thighs while keeping the torso upright. Drive the feet apart into the floor and stand the bar up in one piece, lowering under control with no pause at the top. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight climbs each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run Mix Modal based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2-3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Band or Cable Straight Arm Lat Pulldown; 10-15 reps
1. Seated DB Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Full Snatch + 2 Snatch Push Press + 2 Overhead Squat
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up or Lat Pulldown; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up or Supinated Lat Pulldown; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

F) Run Mix Modal:
For Time @ tough effort
20-16-12-8-4
Alternating DB Snatch
GHD Sit Ups or Anchored Sit Ups
*100m Run between each round
Effort Note: Perform a tough but steady pace. Do not go out too fast. The format: 20 DB Snatch, 20 GHD Sit Up, 100m Run, 16 DB Snatch, 16 GHD Sit Up, 100m Run...

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Half Kneeling Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Prayer Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press

The bench press is the main pressing lift this cycle. Pinch the shoulder blades down and back and keep them there for a stronger, safer base to press from. The 20X1 tempo means a controlled descent, no pause at the bottom, then drive, with the last set a max unbroken effort at your Set 1 weight. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight climbs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Upper Intervals based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
1. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) HS HOT START (15 min):
Every 3 min x 5 Sets
Bike 18/15 Cals
30 Double Unders
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Up

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

F) Upper Intervals (12 min):
Every 4 min x 3 Sets

8 Dual KB Z Press
8 KB Sprawl
8 Dual KB Clean
Row 200m
Effort Note: Control your breathing with the goal of each set being consistent or close to the previous set. Adjust run distance to have at least 45 seconds of rest remaining before the start of the next set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist back squat opens the week on the quads. Raising the heels and staying upright keeps the load on the quads, and the added quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time in the hardest part of the squat. Squat all the way down, come up a quarter, drop back to the bottom, then stand up to finish. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight climbs each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Lower Sprint based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold

10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
2 Low Hang Power Clean + 2 Box Jump Step Down
rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Lower Sprint (10 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
20 sec Bike SPRINT
30 Double Unders
12 Weight Plate Russian Twists (12/side) 35/25\# or 25/10\# (Male/Female)
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note: Use the following guide to approach each set with escalating effort on the Bike.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Total Work - Easy Effort
20 min Timer:
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15 stop and perform:
- 30 sec Wall Sit
- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps R
- 15 Side Plank Hip Taps L
20 min Timer:
Bike or Row Easy - at mins 5, 10, and 15 stop and perform:
- 30 sec Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift
- 15 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold R
- 15 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold L

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x 3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x 8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Bar Dip

The strict bar dip is the main pressing strength work on Fridays. Keep the chest tall and the shoulders packed down, and lower under the 31X1 tempo to load the bottom stretch before driving up. Stay just shy of the shoulders rolling forward at the bottom of each rep. The last set is max unbroken reps, so leave enough to finish strong.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Push Pull based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
1. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
1. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) KB HOT START (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
15/12 Cal Bike
3 Dual KB Sumo Deadlift High Pull
4 Dual KB Russian Swings
5 Dual KB Cleans
rest 30 sec between sets

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Bar Dip
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5-8 reps @31X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12 min Continuous Clock
Bike 500/400m (Male/Female)
10-15 Chest to Bar Kipping Pull Ups
8-12 Deficit Push Up
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
1. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
1. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Rack Split Squat
The front rack split squat is the main single leg strength work to close the week. Holding the bar in the front rack keeps the torso upright and drives the load into the front leg. Keep the front heel planted and the back knee tracking straight down on every rep. Reps drop across the odd weeks so the weight climbs each time it returns.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power 30 based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Front Rack Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Cyclist Front Squat; 8 reps @20X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Power 30 (30 min):
Part 1 — For Time @ Tough Effort (7 min Cap)
20/15 Cal Row
30 DB Hang Power Clean 50/35\# (Male/Female)
40 GHD Sit Ups or 50 Anchored Sit Ups
30 Wall Balls 20/14, 10'/9'
20/15 Cal Row
Effort Note: These Time Caps are intentionally challenging. Work hard to try and get your time under this number, but by no means get down if you don't. You will get a minimum of 3 minutes rest before part 2 regardless. The DB weight you select should require 1-2 breaks, adjust accordingly.
Part 2 — Beginning at 10 min on the clock, Every 5 min x 4 Sets:
20 Jump Lunge
8-10 Devils Press 50/35\# (Male/Female)
8-10 DB Suitcase Box Step Up 50/35\# 16"/12"
8-15 Calorie Row
*rest the remainder of the time before the next 5 min period
Effort Note: Try to keep your times between 2:30-3:30 for each set. If you are taking longer then drop the reps. The DB weight should allow you to perform the movement unbroken for the first set, with the expectation of breaking up a little more each round; adjust accordingly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

New series starting this week. Every Sunday for the next six weeks, we're busting a myth, two on nutrition, two on recovery, two on training. Some of these you've probably heard your whole life. Let's get into it.
There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.
Warmly, Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, August 24th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
DB Bench Press
The dumbbell bench press is your main pressing lift this cycle. Pinch your shoulder blades together and down and keep them there, which protects the shoulder and gives you a stronger base to press from. The 20X1 tempo means two seconds down, no pause at the bottom, then drive up. The last set is max unbroken reps at your first working set weight, so leave enough in the tank to finish strong.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Powell Raise; 10 reps/side
1. Reverse Shoulder Wall Circles; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 15 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):
3 sets
1. Seated DB Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Push Up; 10-25 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. The push up range is wide to accommodate different strength levels.

E) Isometric Fatigue Shoulders (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
1min Farmers Carry 50/35\# (Male/Female)
10 DB Burpees 50/35\#
15 Waiter Curls 50/35\#
1 min Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note: Isometrics are heavily underrated in most training programs. In this section the continuous movement keeps the heart rate high, and the isometrics build strength without sacrificing quality or your joints in the process. Aim for a consistent pace with about 60 sec rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation Sweep; 5 reps/side
1. Childs Pose Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Downdog to Updog; 5-7 reps

Tuesday, August 25th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
1 1/4 Cyclist Goblet Squat
The 1 1/4 cyclist goblet squat adds a quarter rep at the bottom of every rep. Squat all the way down, come up a quarter, drop back to the bottom, then stand all the way up to finish the rep. Raising your heels keeps the work almost entirely on your quads, and the extra quarter doubles your time in the hardest part of the squat. Reps drop every other week so the weight can climb.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Shinbox Switch; 10 reps/side
1. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Cyclist Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Suitcase Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat; 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (15 min):
For Time
400m Run
30 Anchored Sit Ups
30 Air Squat
rest 30sec
300m Run
24 Anchored Sit Ups
24 Air Squat
rest 30sec
200m Run
18 Anchored Sit Ups

18 Air Squat
rest 30sec
100m Run
12 Anchored Sit Ups
12 Air Squat
*15min Time Cap Including Rest Periods
Effort Note: This workout is broken down into small digestible sections. Put good effort into each one, but pace with intention from the beginning.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Frog Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 26th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal - complete 30min of low-intensity steady-state movements today. You can get out for a 30min walk today, go for a hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hips
Shinbox Switch x 6-8
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox IR Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Switch x3-5/side
Low Switch Cossack x8-10/side
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Squat Hold x 1-2 min
Slow Bodyweight Squat x 5

Thursday, August 27th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
Strict Pull Up

Your pulling strength runs as a mechanical drop set this cycle, built around switching grip rather than dropping weight. Start with pronated strict pull ups at a 21X1 tempo, using only as much assistance as you need to hit the reps clean, then flip to a supinated grip and go for max unbroken reps at the same load. The overhand pull is the hardest, so once it fails the underhand grip lets you keep working the same muscles. Reps start at ten this week and come down as the block goes on, so stay strict with no kip and own every rep.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
2-3 Sets
1. Prone Half Angel; 10 SLOW reps
1. Plank to Downdog; 10 reps (5/side)
1. Thoracic Spine Can Opener; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
1. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; Max Unbroken Reps @20X0 Tempo @ same weight.
rest 2 minutes
Loading Note: This is a mechanical drop set. Perform the pronated pull up or pulldown using assistance as necessary to match the reps and tempo prescribed. Use the same amount of assistance/load for the Supinated Strict Pull Up/Pulldown and perform as many reps as possible.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Flat Bench DB Fly; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Push Pull (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
5 Shuttle Run
8-12 Deficit Push Up
10 Right Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\# (Male/Female)

10 Left Arm DB Power Clean 50/35\# or 35/20\#
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.
Effort Note: Aim for a steady pace on all movements. Avoid hitting failure on the bodyweight and DB movements. Take short breaks as needed to keep rest minimal throughout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
1. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
1. Behind the Back Neck Stretch; 30 sec/side
1. Banded Single Arm Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, August 28th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Coach Notes:
DB Sumo RDL
The dumbbell sumo RDL uses a wide stance and a soft knee to load your hamstrings, glutes, and inner thighs through a long stretch. Hold the dumbbells close to your legs, push your hips straight back, and lower only as far as you can while keeping a flat back. The 20X0 tempo means a controlled two second lower with no bounce at the bottom, then stand tall and squeeze your glutes. Reps stay at ten across all three sets while the effort climbs, so nudge the weight up each set to match the rising RPE.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
1. Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
1. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Sumo RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
2-3 sets
1. DB Front Rack Split Squat; 8 reps/side @20X0
rest 60 sec
2. Hamstring Walkout; 40-60 sec
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Interval Weight Training (12 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
15 Dumbbell Swings
10 Box Jump Step Down
30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note: Aim to increase the pace on the row each set. The movements are lower skill, allowing for higher effort output for each set.

F) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30 sec
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
1. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec

Saturday, August 29th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal - complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Superman Hold
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort

Rest 30sec
x8
2-3 Sets
- Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
- 30sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30sec @ 75% effort
Rest 30sec
x8

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7/side
1. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
1. Middle Split x 2 min
1. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10
1. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10
1. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, August 30th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

Nutrition Myth: Carbs make you fat

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There's a nutrition myth that won't die: carbs make you fat. I get it, low carb diets have been marketed hard for years and the logic sounds simple on the surface. But if you're training hard, carbs are doing more for you than almost anything else in your diet. They fuel your workouts, they help you recover, and they keep your energy steady enough to actually show up and push the next day. Fat gain isn't about one macronutrient, it's about total intake over time. I've had clients add carbs back into their diet and get leaner, not because carbs are magic, but because they finally had the energy to train the way their body needed. Stop fearing the food group that's probably fueling your best sessions.

Warmly, Marcus